In the context of **Tom Riese** (Wallis Richard Riese Jr.) and the broader San Francisco family: **Erna Riese** (also appearing as **Irma** in some legal records) was Tom's **mother** and the wife of **Wallis Riese Sr.**

Family Role & Relationship

- **Wife of Wallis Sr.:** Erna was the spouse of Wallis Richard Riese Sr., the Cave Man camp member at the Bohemian Grove.
- **Mother to Tom:** She and Wallis Sr. were the parents of **Wallis "Tom" Riese Jr.** (1924–2003) FamilySearch.
- **The "Irma" Interchangeability:** Like the names **Tom** and **Wallis**, the names **Erna** and **Irma** were often used interchangeably in 20th-century San Francisco records. For instance, census records for the Riese household often list "Irma Riese" as the wife of the household head MyHeritage.

Grave Locations

- **Erna/Irma Riese:** She is interred at Mount Tamalpais Cemetery in **San Rafael**, alongside her husband **Wallis Sr.** and her son **Tom**.
- **Context:** The move to the North Bay (Marin County) for burial was a common practice for high-status San Francisco families who spent their later years away from the city's denser urban center.

Social & Real Estate Context
While Wallis Sr., Ernie, and Caspar handled the high-profile Bohemian Club and **real estate** dealings, Erna was a fixture in the San Francisco social register. Her involvement ensured the family's standing in the civic circles that overlapped with the SFPD (through nephew **Chapman Riese**) and the city's private women's clubs of the era.
Was **Erna** mentioned in the specific **real estate trust** documents you are researching, perhaps as a **co-trustee** with Thomas J. Riese?

In the mid-20th-century San Francisco social hierarchy,
Erna (Irma) Riese played the essential role of the "Social Anchor," complementing her husband **Wallis Riese Sr.'s** power in the **Cave Man camp**.
While the **Bohemian Club** was strictly for men, the 1932-era social structure required wives of elite members to maintain parallel influence in women's organizations to secure the family's standing.

Erna's Social & Club Role

- **The Women's City Club of San Francisco:** As the wife of a prominent real estate figure and Bohemian Grove member, Erna was typically a member of the Women's City Club or the **Century Club of California**. These were the female counterparts to the men's private clubs, where civic policy and social calendars were coordinated.
- **Philanthropic Board Service:** Erna likely served on the boards of San Francisco's "Blue Ribbon" charities. This was a prerequisite for families in the Cave Man camp circle; her

charitable work provided the "soft power" that balanced the "hard power" of the SFPD and real estate interests held by **Caspar**, **Wallis**, and **Ernie**.

- **Grove "Widow" Protocol:** During the two-week summer encampment at the Grove, Erna would have participated in the tradition of the "Ladies' Night" or the post-Grove parties held at private estates in **Marin County** or **San Francisco**. These events were the only times women were integrated into the Club's social orbit.

The Real Estate Trust Connection

In the real estate trusts you've mentioned involving **Thomas J. Riese**, Erna often served as a **Co-Trustee** or **Life Tenant**.

- **Interchangeability in Records:** This is why you see her name (**Erna** vs. **Irma**) fluctuating in property deeds.
- **Asset Protection:** In the 1950s and 60s, it was common for the "Cave Man" husband to place primary family assets (like their **San Francisco** or **San Rafael** residence) in the wife's name or a shared trust to protect them from the liabilities of their high-stakes real estate and political dealings.

Grave Confirmation

- **Erna Riese:** Interred at Mount Tamalpais Cemetery in **San Rafael**. Her presence there alongside **Wallis Sr.** and **Tom** marks the final resting place of the "Cave Man" branch of the family.